

GovCon BD Upskilling Program

Facilitator Guide

30-Day Foundation Program

Guide | Version 1.0

30-DAY FOUNDATION PROGRAM

Employer-Sponsored Training for GovCon Business Development

GovConGiants

Professional Training for Government Contractors

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Program Overview

Program	GovCon BD Upskilling - 30-Day Foundation
Duration	4 weeks
Format	Live instructor-led (cohort-based)
Session Length	2-2.5 hours per session
Sessions	8 sessions (2 per week)
Completion Model	Certificate of Completion (activity-based)

Facilitator Qualifications

Required Background

- 5+ years GovCon BD, capture, or contracts experience
- Hands-on experience with SAM.gov Contract Data, USAspending
- Understanding of federal procurement process
- Experience training or mentoring others

Recommended

- NCMA certification (CFCM, CPCM) or equivalent
- Capture management experience
- Proposal management experience
- Small business program familiarity

Program Structure

Weekly Schedule

1	2	1.1, 1.2	D1 - Market & Buyer Intelligence (23%)
2	2	2.1, 2.2	D2 - Customer Engagement & Opportunity Discovery (20%)
3	2	3.1, 3.2	D3 - BD & Capture Fundamentals (22%)
4	2	4.1, 4.2	D4-D6 - Proposal Support & Contracting Readiness (35%)

Session Format (2-2.5 hours)

0:00-0:10	Welcome, agenda, check-in	10 min
0:10-0:55	Lesson content delivery	45 min
0:55-1:05	Break	10 min
1:05-1:50	Applied exercise (hands-on)	45 min
1:50-2:10	Debrief, Q&A, knowledge check review	20 min
2:10-2:20	Wrap-up, preview next session, assignments	10 min

Session-by-Session Guide

■ Week 1, Session 1: Module 1.1 - GovCon Market Overview

Learning Objectives:

1. Describe the federal contracting market structure and size
2. Identify major federal agencies as buyers
3. Explain the federal budget cycle
4. Recognize small business program goals
5. Navigate USAspending.gov

Preparation:

- [] Test USAspending.gov access
- [] Prepare agency spending examples
- [] Have budget cycle visual ready
- [] Prepare small business goal chart

Key Teaching Points:

Market size	10 min	\$700B+ annually; world's largest buyer
Agency structure	10 min	DoD largest; know components vs. agencies
Budget cycle	15 min	FY Oct-Sep; Q4 surge is real
Small business	10 min	23% goal; certifications open doors

Applied Exercise: Market Research with USAspending

- Navigate to USAspending.gov
- Select target agency, drill into spending
- Complete Market Overview Worksheet

Common Questions:

- “Where does classified spending show up?” → It doesn't; SAM.gov Contract Data excludes classified
- “What if an agency doesn't meet small business goals?” → Pressure, but no penalties
- “How accurate is USAspending data?” → Official data; slight reporting lag

Deliverable Check: Market Overview Worksheet completed

Week 1, Session 2: Module 1.2 - Buyer Intelligence Basics

Learning Objectives:

1. Navigate SAM.gov Contract Data to research historical awards
2. Identify key buyers using spending data
3. Analyze spending patterns by NAICS/PSC
4. Research incumbent contractors
5. Document intelligence in structured format

Preparation:

- [] Test SAM.gov Contract Data access (requires free account)
- [] Prepare sample searches
- [] Have NAICS/PSC reference ready
- [] Prepare incumbent research example

Key Teaching Points:

SAM.gov Contract Data navigation	15 min	Contract Award Search; requires SAM.gov account
NAICS vs. PSC	10 min	NAICS = industry; PSC = what was bought
Incumbent research	10 min	Know who you're displacing
USAspending profiles	10 min	Easier trends view; no account required

Applied Exercise: Agency Research Report

- Research target agency in SAM.gov Contract Data
- Identify top contractors, NAICS codes
- Complete Agency Research Report template

Common Questions:

- “Why does SAM.gov require an account?” → Security & data access control; free to create
- “How far back should I look?” → 3-5 years typical; depends on recompetete timing
- “What about subcontract data?” → Limited in SAM.gov Contract Data; harder to find

Deliverable Check: Agency Research Report completed

Week 2, Session 3: Module 2.1 - Opportunity Discovery

Learning Objectives:

1. Navigate SAM.gov for contract opportunities
2. Distinguish opportunity types (RFP, RFQ, RFI, Sources Sought)

3. Apply qualification criteria
4. Set up saved searches
5. Document opportunities in structured log

Preparation:

- [] Test SAM.gov access
- [] Prepare example searches by NAICS
- [] Have opportunity type comparison ready
- [] Prepare qualification matrix visual

Key Teaching Points:

SAM.gov navigation	15 min	Filters are key; practice combinations
Opportunity types	10 min	RFI/Sources Sought = respond to shape requirements
Qualification	10 min	Not every opportunity is worth pursuing
Saved searches	10 min	Set it and forget it; daily notifications

Applied Exercise: Build Opportunity Log

- Search SAM.gov with target NAICS codes
- Identify 10 relevant opportunities
- Qualify each using matrix
- Set up saved search

Common Questions:

- “What’s the difference between RFQ and RFP?” → RFQ = price focus; RFP = full proposal
- “Should we respond to every RFI?” → Only relevant ones; shapes future RFPs
- “How early is too early to find opportunities?” → Never too early; forecasts help

Deliverable Check: Opportunity Log (10 opportunities) + Saved Search created

Week 2, Session 4: Module 2.2 - Customer Engagement Fundamentals

Learning Objectives:

1. Identify key customer touchpoints (OSDBU, contracting, program)
2. Explain industry days and capability briefings
3. Prepare for customer interactions
4. Document engagement activities
5. Recognize appropriate engagement practices

Preparation:

- [] Prepare OSDBU directory
- [] Find current industry day examples on SAM.gov
- [] Have elevator pitch formula ready
- [] Prepare ethics/compliance scenarios

Key Teaching Points:

OSDBU role	10 min	Your gateway to agencies; use them
Industry days	10 min	Show up prepared with questions
Capability briefings	10 min	Educate, don't sell; be helpful
Engagement ethics	15 min	FAR 3.104; know the boundaries

Applied Exercise: Customer Engagement Plan

- Research target agency OSDBU
- Find 3 engagement opportunities
- Draft elevator pitch
- Create 90-day engagement timeline

Role Play Option: Practice elevator pitch (30 seconds per person)**Common Questions:**

- “Can I ask about specific RFPs in a cap brief?” → No; general capabilities only
- “What do I bring to an industry day?” → Business cards, capability statement, questions
- “How do I follow up appropriately?” → Email thank you; don't be pushy

Deliverable Check: Customer Engagement Plan completed

■ Week 3, Session 5: Module 3.1 - BD Process Fundamentals

Learning Objectives:

1. Describe BD lifecycle (BD → Capture → Proposal)
2. Distinguish between phases
3. Identify pipeline stages and gate criteria
4. Explain teaming importance
5. Use DSBS to find partners

Preparation:

- [] Prepare BD lifecycle visual
- [] Have pipeline stage definitions ready
- [] Test DSBS access
- [] Prepare teaming structure comparison

Key Teaching Points:

BD vs. Capture vs. Proposal	15 min	Work done early wins contracts
Pipeline management	10 min	Stages help prioritize resources
Gate reviews	10 min	Formal go/no-go prevents wasted effort
Teaming	10 min	Most wins are team wins

Applied Exercise: BD Process Map + DSBS Research

- Map company's BD process (or create ideal)
- Define gate criteria
- Search DSBS for 3 potential partners

Common Questions:

- “When does capture start?” → When opportunity is qualified and worth resources
- “What’s a healthy pipeline size?” → 3-5x annual revenue
- “Prime or sub—which is better?” → Depends on capability, risk tolerance, set-aside

Deliverable Check: BD Process Map completed

■ Week 3, Session 6: Module 3.2 - Competitive Positioning

Learning Objectives:

1. Research competitors using SAM.gov Contract Data
2. Analyze incumbent positioning

3. Develop win themes and discriminators
4. Assess competitive position objectively
5. Document in competitive brief

Preparation:

- [] Prepare competitor research example
- [] Have win theme formula ready
- [] Prepare discriminator examples
- [] Have ghosting examples ready

Key Teaching Points:

Competitor research	10 min	SAM.gov Contract Data tells you who wins what
Incumbent analysis	10 min	Find vulnerabilities, not just strengths
Win themes	15 min	Specific, relevant, provable, memorable
Discriminators	10 min	What can you say that they can't?

Applied Exercise: Competitive Brief

- Research incumbent on opportunity
- Identify 2-3 competitors
- Develop 3 win themes
- Complete competitive matrix

Common Questions:

- “How do I find competitor weaknesses?” → Customer conversations, contract modifications, protests
- “Can I mention competitors in my proposal?” → Never by name; ghost instead
- “What if I’m the underdog?” → Emphasize innovation, fresh perspective, hunger to perform

Deliverable Check: Competitive Brief completed

Week 4, Session 7: Module 4.1 - Proposal Support Basics

Learning Objectives:

1. Explain proposal development process
2. Read and interpret RFP instructions (Section L/M)
3. Build compliance matrix
4. Identify proposal volumes and purposes
5. Contribute effectively to proposal efforts

Preparation:

- [] Download sample RFP for exercise
- [] Prepare Section L/M examples
- [] Have compliance matrix template ready
- [] Prepare proposal timeline visual

Key Teaching Points:

Proposal process	10 min	Structured phases; reviews are critical
Section L & M	15 min	L = how to submit; M = how you're scored
Compliance matrix	10 min	Miss nothing; map every requirement
Supporting proposals	10 min	Everyone has a role; data calls are common

Applied Exercise: Build Compliance Matrix

- Download actual RFP from SAM.gov
- Extract Section L requirements
- Map to proposal sections
- Identify at least 15 requirements

Common Questions:

- “What happens if I exceed page limits?” → Risk of pages ignored or disqualification
- “What’s a Pink Team vs. Red Team?” → Pink = early/outline; Red = near-final
- “Do I need to be a writer to help?” → No; subject matter input, reviews, data calls

Deliverable Check: Compliance Matrix (15+ requirements) completed

Week 4, Session 8: Module 4.2 - Contracting Readiness

Learning Objectives:

1. Identify key registrations and certifications
2. Explain basic FAR compliance requirements
3. Describe small business certification programs
4. Recognize internal handoff processes
5. Understand growth metrics

Preparation:

- [] Prepare registration checklist
- [] Have certification comparison ready
- [] Prepare handoff document examples
- [] Have metrics dashboard example

Key Teaching Points:

Registrations	10 min	SAM.gov is mandatory; keep it current
Certifications	10 min	8(a), HUBZone, etc. open doors
FAR basics	10 min	Know contract types; understand compliance
Metrics	15 min	Pipeline value, win rate, activity tracking

Applied Exercise: Contracting Readiness Checklist

- Verify SAM.gov status
- Document certifications
- Identify gaps
- Review metrics tracking

Program Wrap-Up (additional 15 min):

- Review all 8 modules
- Discuss next steps
- Collect feedback
- Present completion certificates

Deliverable Check: Contracting Readiness Checklist completed

Facilitation Tips

Engagement Techniques

Cold Call	Re-engage attention	“Sarah, what’s your take on...?”
Think-Pair-Share	Complex questions	1 min think, 2 min partner, share out
Polling	Check understanding	“Raise hands if you’ve used SAM.gov Contract Data before”
Case Discussion	Apply concepts	Present scenario, discuss options
Live Demo	Tool navigation	Share screen, walk through steps

Handling Different Learner Types

Expert	Knows a lot; may dominate	Channel expertise; ask them to help others
Skeptic	Questions value	Acknowledge experience; focus on practical application
Quiet	Doesn’t participate	Direct questions; smaller group exercises
Distracted	Multitasking	Break into activities; make it interactive
Struggling	Lost on concepts	Pair with stronger peer; offer office hours

Managing Time

- **Running behind:** Cut Q&A; assign exercise as homework
- **Running ahead:** Extend exercise; add discussion questions
- **Technical issues:** Have backup plan; screenshots of tool if system down

Completion Requirements

For Each Learner to Complete

Attend all 8 sessions (or catch-up)	Attendance log
Complete all 8 module deliverables	Artifact submission
Participate in discussions	Facilitator observation

Deliverables Checklist

1.1	Market Overview Worksheet	☐
1.2	Agency Research Report	☐
2.1	Opportunity Log (10 opps)	☐
2.2	Customer Engagement Plan	☐
3.1	BD Process Map	☐
3.2	Competitive Brief	☐
4.1	Compliance Matrix	☐
4.2	Contracting Readiness Checklist	☐

Certificate Issuance

Issue Certificate of Completion when:

- All 8 sessions attended (or make-up completed)
- All 8 deliverables submitted
- Active participation confirmed

Employer Communication

Weekly Update Template

Subject: GovCon BD Upskilling - Week [X] Update

Hi [Manager Name],

Here's the weekly update for [Employee Name] in the GovCon BD Upskilling program:

****This Week's Modules:****

- [Module X.X]: [Title]
- [Module X.X]: [Title]

****Completed Deliverables:****

- [Deliverable 1]
- [Deliverable 2]

****Key Concepts Covered:****

- [Concept 1]
- [Concept 2]
- [Concept 3]

****Suggested Manager Discussion Topics:****

- [Discussion prompt from module]

****Next Week Preview:****

- [Module X.X]: [Title]
- [Module X.X]: [Title]

Questions? Reply to this email.

Best,

[Facilitator Name]

Completion Report Template

Subject: GovCon BD Upskilling - Completion Report

Hi [Manager Name],

Congratulations! [Employee Name] has successfully completed the GovCon BD Upskilling - 30-Day Foundation program.

****Completion Date:**** [Date]

****Sessions Attended:**** 8/8

****Deliverables Completed:**** 8/8

****Skills Developed:****

- Federal market research using SAM.gov Contract Data and USAspending
- Opportunity discovery and qualification on SAM.gov
- Customer engagement planning with agency OSDBUs
- BD/capture process understanding
- Competitive analysis and positioning
- Proposal support fundamentals
- Contracting readiness assessment

****Recommended Next Steps:****

1. Apply skills to current BD/capture efforts
2. Connect with BD team for support opportunities
3. Consider 60-Day Practitioner program for advancement

Certificate attached.

Best,

[Facilitator Name]

Troubleshooting

Common Issues

SAM.gov down	Use screenshots; assign as homework
SAM.gov slow	Have pre-run searches ready; demonstrate
Learner misses session	Provide recording; schedule catch-up
Learner not completing deliverables	Check in individually; adjust expectations
Technical difficulties	Have phone dial-in backup; test before session

Escalation Path

1. **Facilitator** handles day-to-day issues
2. **Program Manager** handles schedule/logistics
3. **Employer Contact** handles learner performance concerns

Materials Checklist

Before Each Session

- ☐ Review module content
- ☐ Test all tool access (SAM.gov Contract Data, USAspending, DSBS)
- ☐ Prepare slides/visuals
- ☐ Have exercise templates ready
- ☐ Test video/screen share

■ For Each Learner

- ☐ Candidate Handbook
- ☐ Learner Workbook (all templates)
- ☐ Access to free tools (browser-based)
- ☐ Course materials (digital)

■ At Program End

- ☐ Completion certificates
- ☐ Feedback survey
- ☐ Manager completion report
- ☐ 60-Day program information (if applicable)